

Differential Expression Part 3

- 1-page summary of your proposed project due on March 3rd
- Today's lab activity is 07_DE_DESeq2_limma.qmd

DESeq2 Analysis Pipeline Overview

- 1) Load count data (column 1 = gene names, subsequent columns are counts for samples, row names are headings)
- 2) Create “DESeqDataSet” for your samples that assigns metadata to counts (contains the contrasts of interest, similar to the “contrast matrix” that is used by edgeR)
 - a) main difference is there is a common reference by default (intercept)
- 3) Filter out genes with low counts
- 4) Perform all normalization steps and differential expression testing (combines all of median-of-ratios normalization for library size and composition with estimating dispersions)
- 5) Write table of outputs (logFC, p-values, FDR-adjusted p-values)

limma voom Analysis Pipeline Overview

Very similar to edgeR (same group created both)

- 1) Load count data (column 1 = gene names, subsequent columns are counts for samples, row names are headings)
- 2) Create “groups” for your samples that you want to compare (e.g., group 1 = WT unstressed, group 2 = WT EtOH stressed, group 3 = mutant unstressed, group 4 = mutant stressed)
- 3) Create a “design matrix” that assigns groups to the samples in your count table
- 4) Create a “contrast matrix” for your comparisons of interest (e.g., group 1 (WT unstressed) vs group 2 (WT EtOH stressed))

limma voom Analysis Pipeline Overview

- 5) Filter out genes with low counts
- 6) Normalize to total reads per sample and composition (TMM)
- 7) Convert counts to logCPM
- 8) Apply voom transformation to logCPM data (estimates the mean-variance relationship of the log-counts, generates a precision weight for each observation)
- 9) Fit a linear model to each gene (lmFit function)
- 10) Use empirical Bayes to “squeeze” variance towards a common value and perform a moderated F test
- 11) Write table of outputs (logFC, p-values, FDR-adjusted p-values)

Comparison Across Methods

Method	Normalization	Model	Test
edgeR	TMM	Negative binomial GLM	Quasi-likelihood F test
DESeq2	Median-of-ratios	Negative binomial GLM	Wald test (or LRT)
limma-voom	TMM + voom weights	Linear model on log-CPM	Moderated F test

- edgeR/DESeq2: Model counts directly with negative binomial distribution
- limma-voom: Transform counts to log scale, model with normal distribution using precision weights